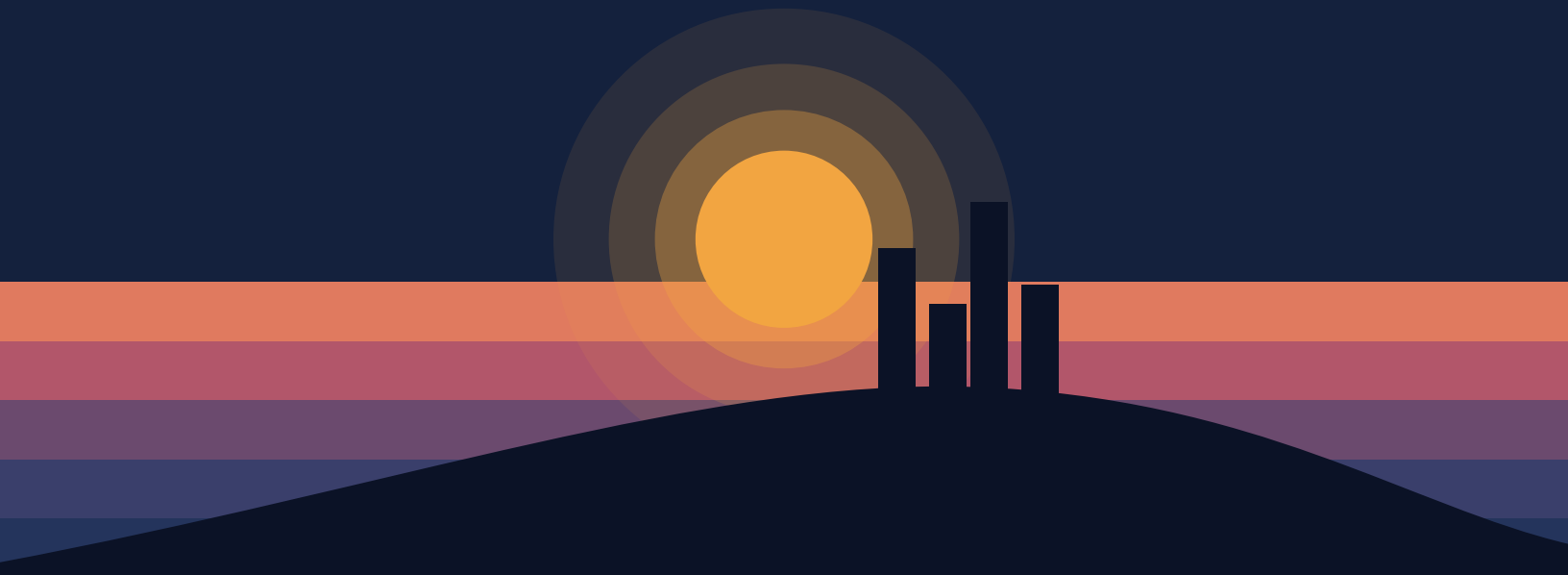
THE WOLF OF McKENZIE TOWNE • SEASON ONE

NOW CASTING MENTORS

Co-op and practicum placements for a community-wide theatre production

Hard work • Vision • Creativity • Fun



THEATRE: Direction & Performance • Design & Stage Management
MARKETING: Campaign & Publicity • Partnerships & Sponsorship
PAID CO-OP: Marketing & Production Coordinator

Season One • Calgary SE • 2027

About the Production

The stage is a neighbourhood. The cast is a whole community. The curtain rises at dusk.

The Wolf of McKenzie Towne is a **community-wide theatre production** in the form of an Amazing Race. On one summer evening in **late August 2027**, clans of teens will race through the parks of McKenzie Towne, a village-style community in southeast Calgary, to recover the stolen *Lantern of the North* from a villain called **the Wolf**.

Every park is a set. Every challenge is a scene: a bank heist at Firetruck Park, a pirate-or-castle choice at the Pirate & Castle Park, a power ballad for a wigged tribunal in the gazebo, a pool-noodle joust with a dragon, and a chase up Elgin Hill at dusk to the castle ruins. It ends with a finale where the Lantern is relit and **the entire neighbourhood switches on its porch lights**.

The production at a glance

Cast	50–70 teen racers, a Youth Race Council of 10–12 teen leaders, costumed characters (a 347-year-old Laird, the Wolf, a dragon, a tribunal)
Crew	30+ adult volunteers, merchants, families and student mentors
Audience	The whole community, from porches, lawn chairs and the finale square
Venue	Eight themed parks, a High Street and a hilltop "ruin"
Run	One night only (plus a family matinee for younger kids)

It's **youth-led and adult-supported**. A Youth Race Council of teens, including 4-H officers, designs and runs the show through a twelve-mission planning season. **That's where you come in.** We're looking for post-secondary students who bring **hard work, vision, creativity and fun** to coach those young leaders and help bring the production to life.

Host: [Host organization: McKenzie Towne community partner], on behalf of the Youth Race Council
Location: McKenzie Towne, Calgary SE (planning sessions at McKenzie Towne Hall, plus some remote work) **Website / contact:** [Contact name] · [Email] · [Phone]

Posting 1 · Theatre Mentor: Direction & Performance

Practicum / community service-learning placement

Role in the production: Assistant Director and Character Coach

Placement type	Practicum, internship or community service-learning (for credit)
Programs	Drama, Theatre Arts, Performance, Applied Theatre, Theatre for Young Audiences
Term	Winter term (January–April 2027), with an option to continue through race day in late August
Hours	About 3–5 hours a week, including one weekly evening planning session (about 90 minutes)
Compensation	Course credit, plus a **$750 season honorarium** (subject to funding)
Positions	1

What you'll do

- **Bring the characters to life.** Lead the character-creation and casting workshops (Mission 3, "The Legend"). Coach the teens playing the Laird, the Wolf, Dodgy Dougal, the Dragon and the Gazebo Tribunal.
- **Shape the script.** Help the Story Crew write the opening, the Wolf's taunts, the QR-code video scripts and the finale.
- **Direct the videos.** Direct the Laird and Wolf videos that play at each station (Mission 9).
- **Stage the trials.** Help the Station Captains turn each challenge into a short, playable scene.
- **Run the dress rehearsal like a tech run.** Pacing, cues, transitions and the finale countdown (Mission 10).
- **Coach presence.** Teach stage presence and voice to teens pitching sponsors and presenting to community boards.
- **On race day:** support the performers and help call the finale.

What you'll gain

- A credited directing and devising role in a large-scale, site-specific community production
- Experience in applied theatre and theatre for young audiences, working with youth ensembles
- Portfolio material: production photos, video, scripts and a highlight reel
- A reference letter from the production leads

You might be a fit if you…

- are studying drama, theatre or a related field and love ensemble and devised work
- can direct with warmth, energy and a sense of humour
- are reliable, organized, and comfortable coaching teens aged 13–18
- believe theatre belongs in parks as much as on stages

Posting 2 · Theatre Mentor: Design & Stage Management

Practicum / community service-learning placement

Role in the production: Production Designer and Stage Manager

Placement type	Practicum, internship or community service-learning (for credit)
Programs	Theatre Production, Design (costume, set, props), Stage Management, Fine Arts
Term	Winter term (January–April 2027), with an option to continue through race day in late August
Hours	About 3–5 hours a week, including one weekly evening planning session, plus build days in spring and summer
Compensation	Course credit, plus a **$750 season honorarium** (subject to funding)
Positions	1

What you'll do

- **Design the world.** Lead the visual design of costumes, sets and props across eight themed park "sets," on a community budget.
- **Build the Lantern.** Guide the youth build crew in creating the giant Lantern finale prop (a frame, LED lighting and fog), the Wolf Pack cloaks, the Laird's costume and the station props.
- **Stage-manage the season.** Keep the production calendar, prop inventory, run sheets and station cue sheets.
- **Plan the night.** Map the course "blocking": where performers stand, how clans move, and where the walk zones and chase zones are.
- **Make it safe and sustainable.** Work with the adult Safety Officer on set safety. Design for reuse in Season Two.
- **On race day:** call the show from production command, with radios, cue sheets and a calm voice.

What you'll gain

- Design and stage-management credits on a site-specific production with real scale
- Experience leading and teaching a youth build crew
- Portfolio material: design renderings, build photos, run sheets and production records
- A reference letter from the production leads

You might be a fit if you…

- are studying theatre production, design or stage management
- love resourceful, low-budget, high-impact design
- are organized, detail-minded and calm under pressure
- enjoy teaching hands-on skills to teens

Posting 3 · Marketing Mentor: Campaign & Publicity

Practicum / community service-learning / capstone placement

Role in the production: Publicity Director and Media Coach

Placement type	Practicum, community service-learning, or capstone project (for credit)
Programs	Marketing, Communications, Public Relations, Digital Media, Business
Term	Winter term (January–April 2027), with an option to continue through race day in late August
Hours	About 3–5 hours a week, including one weekly evening planning session
Compensation	Course credit, plus a **$750 season honorarium** (subject to funding)
Positions	1 (capstone teams welcome to apply together)

What you'll do

- **Build the campaign.** Coach the teen Media Crew in planning and running the publicity rollout: a retro pulp-adventure poster series, an invitation comic, social media, school and youth-group outreach, and door-to-door "Porch Cheer" recruitment (Mission 8).
- **Fill the cast.** Plan and drive racer registration and volunteer recruitment.
- **Tell the story.** Develop the key messages for parents, sponsors and volunteers: building community, building neighbour relationships, building youth.
- **Coach a board pitch.** Help the youth prepare and deliver a presentation to community boards and funders.
- **Measure it.** Set simple goals (registrations, reach, volunteers) and help write a short impact report for funders (Mission 12).
- **On race day:** lead media command, with live social coverage, photos and leaderboard updates.

What you'll gain

- A full, live integrated campaign for your portfolio, from brand to launch to results
- Experience with community engagement, youth audiences and non-profit marketing
- Measurable results you can put on a resume
- A reference letter from the production leads

You might be a fit if you…

- are studying marketing, communications or a related field
- have a creative eye and an organized, data-curious mind
- can explain your craft to teens without taking over
- think the best campaigns get whole neighbourhoods talking

Posting 4 · Marketing Mentor: Partnerships & Sponsorship

Practicum / community service-learning / capstone placement

Role in the production: Producer and Partnerships Coach

Placement type	Practicum, community service-learning, or capstone project (for credit)
Programs	Marketing, Business, Non-profit Management, Event Management
Term	Winter term (January–April 2027), with an option to continue through race day in late August
Hours	About 3–5 hours a week, including one weekly evening planning session
Compensation	Course credit, plus a **$750 season honorarium** (subject to funding)
Positions	1 (capstone teams welcome to apply together)

What you'll do

- **Build the sponsor program.** Refine the sponsorship tiers (Laird's Circle, Clan Champion, Station Sponsor, Merchant Partner) and the materials that go with them.
- **Coach the pitch.** Train the teen Treasury Crew to give a confident 60-second sponsor pitch, and go with them to meet High Street merchants (Mission 7).
- **Steward partners.** Track partner commitments, recognition and thank-yous, so every sponsor and volunteer feels valued.
- **Support funding applications.** Help the adult leads prepare grant materials and letters of support.
- **Mind the budget.** Help the youth understand and track the production budget.
- **On race day:** host sponsors and partners, and run the recognition moments at the finale.

What you'll gain

- Hands-on experience in sponsorship, partnership development and non-profit fundraising
- A complete partnership program for your portfolio
- Connections with local businesses and community organizations
- A reference letter from the production leads

You might be a fit if you…

- are studying marketing, business or event management
- enjoy relationships, persuasion and follow-through
- are professional, warm and dependable
- want to see what one great pitch can do for a community

Posting 5 · Co-op: Marketing & Production Coordinator (Paid)

Paid co-op work term

Role in the production: Production Coordinator, the person who keeps the whole show moving

Placement type	Paid co-op work term
Programs	Marketing, Communications, Business, Event or Arts Management
Term	About 14 weeks, May–August 2027, ending after race day in late August
Hours	35 hours a week, with some evenings and weekends (especially near race day)
Compensation	**$18.00/hour** (subject to funding)
Positions	1
Eligibility	Enrolled in a post-secondary co-op program; Canadian citizen, permanent resident or protected person (needed for wage-subsidy eligibility)

What you'll do

- **Run the production schedule.** Turn the plan into a week-by-week production calendar and keep every crew on track through the final campaign: build, rehearse, race and debrief.
- **Lead the summer publicity push.** Carry out the campaign: posters, social media, school and community outreach, and registration.
- **Coordinate registration and volunteers.** Manage clan registration, bursaries, the volunteer schedule and briefings.
- **Coordinate partners and logistics.** Serve as day-to-day contact for merchants, sponsors, schools and the parks. Manage the props inventory, supplies, the food plan and vendor bookings.
- **Support the Youth Race Council.** Work alongside the Head Game Masters as their production partner, not their boss.
- **Run race day, then wrap the season.** Check-in, station readiness, communications and the finale; then the highlight-reel premiere, thank-yous and impact report.

What you'll gain

- Full-cycle production and event-management experience on a community-wide event
- Leadership experience coordinating volunteers, partners and youth, plus a substantial portfolio of campaign assets and results
- A reference letter, and first consideration for a Season Two role

You might be a fit if you…

- are a co-op student in marketing, communications, business or event management
- are highly organized, proactive and good at juggling many moving parts

- communicate clearly with teens, parents, volunteers and business owners, with energy, humour and steady follow-through

What Every Role Shares

The four things we're looking for

- **Hard work.** This is a real production with real deadlines and real teens counting on you.
- **Vision.** Help the youth see what their community could become in one night.
- **Creativity.** Invent, adapt and solve problems on a community budget.
- **Fun.** If you aren't having fun, neither is the cast. Bring the joy.

How mentors work with youth

- **The youth lead, and you sharpen them.** You coach, ask questions and teach skills. You don't take over.
- **Weekly rhythm:** one evening planning session per week (following the Youth Council's twelve-mission planning guide), plus flexible project time.
- **Supervision:** you'll have a named on-site supervisor and adult allies at every session. We'll complete any learning plans and evaluations your program requires.

Safeguarding requirements (all roles)

- A **police information check with vulnerable-sector verification** (we'll guide you through it)
- Following the **two-adult rule**: never alone with a youth
- Communicating with youth only in **group channels that include an adult ally**
- A short orientation on youth safeguarding, the Council Charter and reporting duties

Inclusion We welcome applicants of every background, ability and experience. If you need accommodations to apply or take part, tell us and we'll work with you.

How to Apply

Send the following to **[Email]** with the subject line **"Lantern Mentor: [Posting number and title]"**:

1. **Your resume** (one to two pages)
2. **A portfolio sample or link** (production photos, designs, campaign work, scripts or video; whatever shows your craft)
3. **A one-page creative response** to the prompt for your role:

- **Posting 1 (Direction & Performance):** *Write the Laird's 60-second welcome speech for the opening ceremony.*
- **Posting 2 (Design & Stage Management):** *Sketch or describe how you'd build the giant Lantern on a $700 budget.*
- **Posting 3 (Campaign & Publicity):** *Pitch a three-week teaser campaign that makes teens desperate to join a clan.*
- **Posting 4 (Partnerships & Sponsorship):** *Write the 60-second pitch a teen could give a High Street café owner.*
- **Posting 5 (Co-op Coordinator):** *Describe how you'd organize the last two weeks before race day.*

4. **Your program and placement details:** school, program, term dates, required hours, and any placement paperwork or learning outcomes we need to support.

Application deadline: [Date] · **Interviews:** [Dates] · **Start:** [January 2027 for practicum roles / May 2027 for the co-op]

For placement coordinators and faculty: we welcome a call to discuss learning outcomes, supervision, evaluation and any agreements your program needs. Contact **[Name]** at **[Phone / Email]**.

Honoraria and co-op wages depend on confirmed funding. Final details will be set out in each placement agreement.